

2 Day Basic Beginner Routine

One full-body workout, twice a week

Do the same workout twice a week with 2–3 rest days between sessions (e.g. Monday and Thursday). Every lift is trained both days. Rest 2–3 minutes between work sets.

The Workout (both days)

- Squat — 3 x 8–12
- Bench Press — 3 x 8–12
- Rows — 3 x 8–12
- Deadlift — 1 x 5
- Lat Pulldown OR Chin-ups — 3 x 8–12
- Standing Barbell Press — 3 x 8–12

Warm Up

- 2 warm-up sets per exercise before work sets.
- Set 1: lightest weight, 10 easy reps.
- Set 2: add weight, 5 reps. Then begin work sets.

3 x 8–12 Explained

- 3 sets of 8 to 12 reps.
- Under 8 reps = too heavy. Go lighter.
- 12 reps on all 3 sets = add smallest weight increment next time.

Superset Option

Optionally alternate bench and rows — one set each, back and forth. May not work in a busy gym.

Exercise Alternatives

- Bench Press: Dumbbell Bench, Chest Machine, Push-ups/Dips
- Rows: Barbell Row, Machine Row, TRX Row
- Standing Press: Dumbbell Press, Machine Shoulder Press
- Squat: Lunges, Leg Press, Step-ups
- Deadlift: Hamstring Curl Machine

Starting Out

- Start lighter than you think.
- Use smaller bars (5–15 kg) if a 20 kg bar is too heavy.
- Pick one alternative and stick with it for months.

Weight Log